BROWZ

User guide

Windows desktop & Android mobile

A practical guide to browsing, tabs, privacy controls and traffic tools.

Read before installing: Browz is experimental. The public Android APK is an old build signed with an exposed key, so it is not a trusted security update. A newer 1.0.3 preview APK (the interface shown in this guide) is published as a pre-release with a direct download link; it is newer but still signed with that exposed key.

Guide prepared: 29 October 2026. Screenshots show a clean test environment, not your personal data.

Inside: downloads and versions • desktop navigation • Android navigation • tabs and bookmarks • traffic tools • privacy limits • troubleshooting.

Start here

Windows: Download standalone installer (.exe)

Android (newest, recommended for testing): Download Browz Mobile 1.0.3 preview (.apk)

Android (old public build): Historical APK 1.0.2 — security warning applies

All published files: GitHub v1.0.0 release page

The public Android filename says 1.0.0 but that build reports version 1.0.2. The 1.0.3 preview shows “Browz 1.0.3” on its start page, so you can tell the two apart. The preview page also lists its SHA-256 checksum file.

1 Downloads, versions and safety

Platform	Available download	What you should know
Windows 64-bit	Standalone installer (~99 MiB)	Public v1.0.0-named installer; runs Browz as a separate Electron/Chromium app, not in Edge. The installer source labels its app version 1.0.2.
Android 7.0+ (API 24+)	Historical APK (~44 KiB)	Old public build, configured as version 1.0.2. The key used to sign it is exposed. Do not treat it as a trusted security update.
Android 1.0.3 preview	Preview APK (~48 KiB)	Newer interface with the menu, persistent bookmarks and more honest request logging: the build shown in this guide. It is a preview, not a trusted security update, and it uses the exposed signing key.

Android update conflict: the same app ID does not guarantee an update. Android also requires an accepted signing certificate. A safe replacement-key migration may require a fresh install and may erase app data. Back up any information you can safely export before removing an app.

Windows installation: Download the standalone EXE, open the file from Downloads, review the Windows security prompt and publisher information, then follow the installer. Choose the install folder if prompted and launch Browz. Do not bypass security warnings unless you have verified the file and understand the risk.

Android installation: Tap the 1.0.3 preview download link, open the downloaded file and allow installs from your browser when Android asks. Because the preview uses the same app ID and signing key as the public build, it installs over an existing Browz installation without uninstalling. If Android reports a signature mismatch, uninstall the old copy first (its data is erased). Android may ask you to allow installs from the download source; remove that permission afterwards. Verify the start page title includes “1.0.3” before relying on the new features (the screenshots in this guide were taken just before that version label was added). Treat it as a test build, not a trusted release.

Check the file before you install it

1. Download the APK and SHA256SUMS.txt from the release page.

2. On a computer with the repository, run tools/verify-download.sh Browz-Mobile-1.0.3-preview.apk SHA256SUMS.txt. It prints the checksum, verifies the signature and shows the certificate fingerprint.

3. If the checksum does not match, delete the file. If the fingerprint is the historical one, the script warns you that this build is a preview, not a trusted update.

Windows users can do the same with Get-FileHash and keytool -printcert -jarfile . A valid signature only proves who signed the file; it cannot fix a leaked signing key.

2 What Browz is for

Browz is an experimental browser: you can open websites, use several tabs, adjust certain privacy settings and inspect some network activity. The desktop and Android apps do not offer the same capabilities.

Need	Windows desktop	Android
Browse, tabs, bookmarks	Address bar, multiple tabs, bookmark star and quick links.	Address bar, tabs and star. Persistent bookmarks and the menu are in newer 1.0.3 work, not the old APK.
See traffic	Traffic panel, filters, request details and export choices. Coverage is not guaranteed.	A partial request observation log in the newer build. It cannot show real response status or body for each request.
Separate accounts	Session/container controls are available. Verify your particular use case before relying on isolation.	WebView tabs share cookies and site storage. Low-cache / Ghost tabs do not isolate accounts.
Change privacy settings	Shields & Settings offers privacy, network, sessions and permissions controls.	Privacy controls offer best-effort settings. Some pages may break.
Find / video	Find, zoom and Fit Video controls.	Find, text zoom and Fit Video are available through Tools or the newer menu.

Neither app is Tor or a VPN. Websites can see your IP, and your network operator can see traffic metadata. No option guarantees anonymity, blocks every request, or makes a device uncompromisable.

3 Windows: find your way around

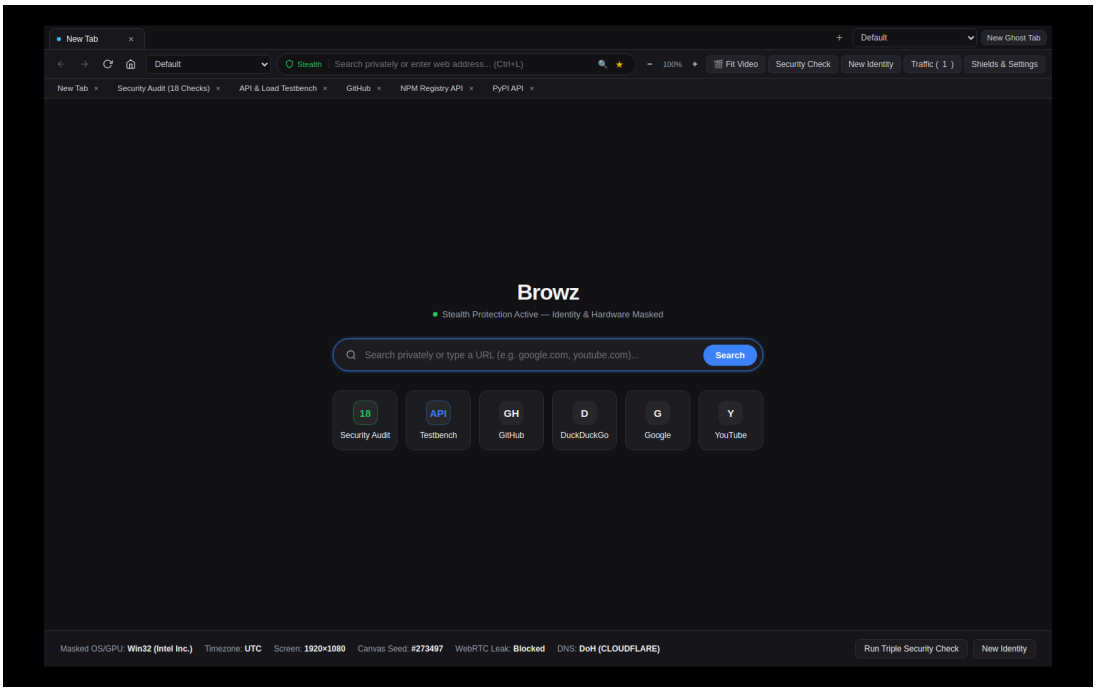


Figure 1. Actual Electron app in a clean Linux test environment at the current source revision. The Windows installer uses the desktop interface; spacing and window decorations may differ.

Top row: the tab strip shows open pages. The plus button opens another tab; the container selector chooses a session for a new tab. A tab’s close control closes that tab.

Second row: Back, Forward, Reload and Home sit next to the address/search field. Other controls include bookmark star, zoom, Fit Video, Security Check, New Identity, Traffic and Shields & Settings.

Main area: the large center region is the webpage. Traffic opens a bottom panel; Shields & Settings opens a side panel. Close those panels when you want more room for a page.

Open a page

1. Click the address/search field or press **Ctrl+L**.

2. Type a website address such as **https://example.com**, or enter search words.

3. Press **Enter**. Use Back and Forward to move through pages, or Reload to try the current page again.

Page load failures and missing features can occur due to site restrictions, settings, network errors or browser compatibility.

4 Windows: tabs and everyday tools

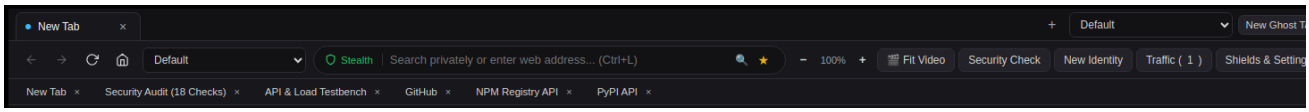


Figure 1a. Enlarged crop of the actual desktop toolbar shown on the previous page.

Use more than one tab

1. Click **+** on the tab strip to open a tab.

2. Click a tab title to return to it. Use its close control to close it.

3. To try different sessions, choose a container in the selector before opening a new tab. Sessions and their data policies should be tested for your own workflow.

Save, find and adjust

• **Bookmark:** open a page and click the star near the address bar. Use the bookmarks bar to revisit saved links.

• **Find:** press Ctrl+F, type a word and use the arrows to move between matches. Escape closes the find bar.

• **Zoom:** use the minus and plus near the address bar; select the percentage to reset.

• **Video:** use **Fit Video** on a page containing a video; press Esc to exit when supported. Results vary by website.

• **New Identity:** rotates selected browser-facing settings and clears session data; you may be signed out. It does not change your network IP or create anonymity.

Useful shortcuts

Action	Shortcut
Focus address	Ctrl+L
Find in page	Ctrl+F
Reload	Ctrl+R or F5
Close search / exit fit, when supported	Esc

5 Windows: traffic and settings

Inspect a request

1. Click **Traffic** to open the bottom panel and browse or reload a page.

2. Use the search field and filters for method, type, status or tab to narrow the list. Click a row for available details.

3. Use **REC** to toggle recording and **Clear** to clear the visible capture. Close the panel to expand the webpage.

The panel may show timing, status, headers or bodies when those details are available. Captures can be incomplete and may contain passwords, cookies, tokens or personal URLs. Review before sharing.

Export or replay (advanced)

In the Traffic panel, use **HAR**, **k6**, **JMeter**, **CSV** or **JSON** to export captured information. Composer / Load Burst lets you send or repeat requests. Only send requests to systems you are authorized to test; repeats can change data or overload a service.

Privacy, sessions and permissions

Select **Shields & Settings**; choose **Stealth**, **I/O & Wi-Fi**, **Network**, **Sessions** or **Permissions**. Change one setting at a time and reload the page. A blocking setting may prevent login, downloads, media or a website from working.

> The names of controls may sound stronger than their verified behavior. Simulated Wi-Fi/radio values are not control of your physical device; do not rely on these settings as a firewall or a guarantee of anonymity. A Security Check is illustrative, not an independent audit.

6 Android: revised interface (1.0.3 work)

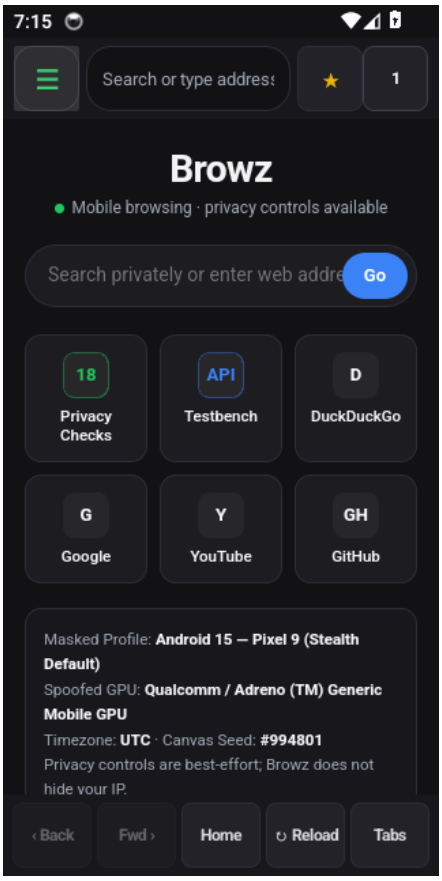


Figure 2. Android 34 emulator, newer 1.0.3 development build. Screen protection was disabled only in the screenshot test; this is not a public release screenshot.

Top: menu on the left, address/search field, bookmark star and tab count. **Bottom:** Back, Forward, Home, Reload/Stop and Tabs. Touch the address field, type a search or URL and press Go on the keyboard.

Public APK is different: the old 1.0.2 app shows a Shield button and a separate Tools button at the top, with Traffic and New ID at the bottom. It does not have the newer menu, persistent bookmarks or truthful request-status wording described on the next pages.

7 Android: menu and tabs

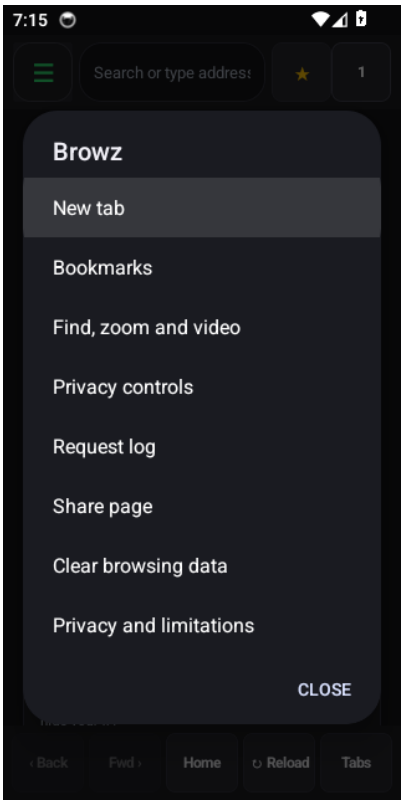


Figure 3. Newer 1.0.3 development build: Browser menu. Not the layout of the historical downloadable APK.

Tap the **menu** (three horizontal lines) to open: New tab, Bookmarks, Find, zoom and video, Privacy controls, Network rules, Containers (separate logins), Hardware & permissions, Request log, Share page, Clear browsing data, and Privacy and limitations. The menu title also shows which container you are in.

Figure 3 was captured before the Network rules, Containers and Hardware entries were added, so it lists fewer items than your build shows.

Do you need an account? No

Browz has no Browz account, no sign-up, no sync and no telemetry. You open the app and browse; there is nothing to sign in to. The “sign in” that matters is the sign-in on the websites you visit, and that is what containers keep apart. Bookmarks, container names, your network rules and a “session open” marker are the only things saved, all in the app’s private storage on this device.

Two honest exceptions: Android WebView Safe Browsing may ask Google whether an address is dangerous (no account involved), and websites obviously see you when you visit them. Browz sends nothing about you to the Browz project because there is no Browz server.

If you never sign in anywhere, you can still use every feature: tabs, containers, network rules, request log, find and zoom.

Containers: keep two accounts apart

1. Tap the menu, then **Containers (accounts)**. The list shows your containers; the filled circle is the active one.

2. Tap **Switch** next to another container. Browz closes every open page, wipes cookies and site storage, and opens a fresh start page in that container.

3. Sign in to the account you want inside that container. Repeat with the other container for a second account.

4. Use **+ New container** to add more spaces (up to 12) and **Clear** to erase the active one.

Isolation is per container, not per tab: tabs inside one container share cookies. Sessions end when you close Browz, and container data is never written to disk. Switching containers signs you out of the previous one.

Open, switch and close tabs

1. Tap the number at the top or **Tabs** at the bottom.

2. Choose **+ New Tab**, or tap a listed tab to switch to it.

3. Choose **Close Active Tab** to close the current one. If it is the last tab, the app rotates identity and returns home rather than closing the window.

A **Low-cache tab** requests less caching, but shares cookies and site storage with other tabs. In the historical APK it is misleadingly called Ghost Tab (RAM); it is not an isolated private session.

8 Android: bookmarks and page tools

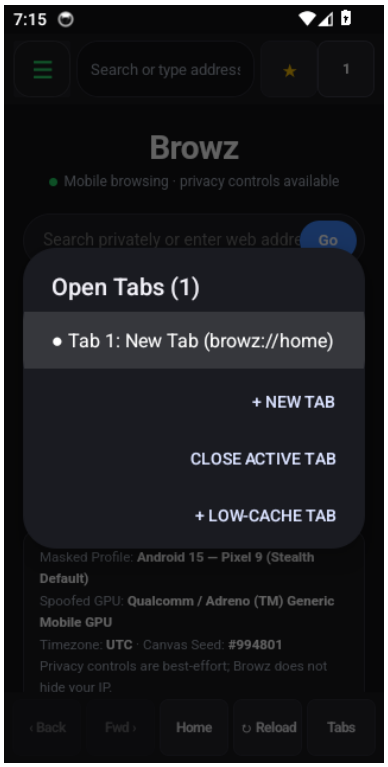


Figure 4. Android emulator: newer development build tab selector. Actual labels or layout may vary by device.

Save or remove a bookmark (newer build)

1. Open a page and tap the star next to the address. A filled star means the current address is saved.

2. Tap Menu → **Bookmarks**, then choose an item to revisit it.

3. To remove it, revisit the page and tap the filled star. Bookmarks remain after app relaunch in the newer build and are not deleted by Clear browsing data.

Bookmarks are stored in app-private storage without application-level encryption and may contain sensitive addresses. The 1.0.3 preview keeps them across restarts; the public APK keeps them only for the session.

Find, zoom and video

In the newer build choose Menu → **Find, zoom and video**. Use Zoom Out, 100% or Zoom In to adjust text. Type a word and select Find / Next Match / Clear. Fit Video attempts to enlarge a page video; it may not work on every site. The historical APK uses the top **Tools** button instead.

9 Android: sharing, privacy and traffic

Share a page (newer build)

Open the page, then choose Menu → **Share page** and select the app or contact. The receiving app can see the shared URL; links can contain private tokens or search terms.

Clear browsing data (newer build)

1. Tap Menu → **Clear browsing data**.

2. Read the confirmation and tap **Clear** or **Cancel**.

3. Expect sign-outs: cookies, site storage, cache, history and the request log are cleared across tabs. Bookmarks are kept; remove them separately.

Cookie deletion is asynchronous; loaded pages and active requests can remain. Clearing is not guaranteed forensic erasure. The older APK does not have this menu option.

Network rules: block or allow by site

1. Open Menu → **Network rules**.

2. Type a domain such as ads.example.com, then choose **Block domain** or **Allow domain**.

3. Tap a saved rule to remove it, then **Reload page** to apply your changes.

A blocked domain never receives the request, which covers trackers, pixels and analytics the built-in list does not know. An allow entry exempts a site from the tracker list when blocking breaks a login or payment page. Rule matching is exact-domain or subdomain only, so blocking example.com also blocks ads.example.com but not exampleX.com.

"Measure real response status" sends one extra HEAD request per top-level page, without page cookies, so the log can show a real code such as HTTP 200 or HTTP 404. Servers may answer HEAD differently from the page load, so treat a probe result as indicative, not proof.

Hardware and permissions

1. Open Menu → **Hardware & permissions**.

2. Read the enforced list: camera, microphone and location cannot be used by pages because the app declares no such permission.

3. Toggle **Block screenshots**, **Block file downloads**, sensor/USB/Bluetooth scripting, clipboard reads or local file pickers.

4. Tap **Reload page** after changes.

The lower part of that screen lists what Browz cannot control: the system keyboard can observe typed text, accessibility services and device administrators can read the screen, and your network provider sees connection metadata.

Privacy controls

Newer build: Menu → **Privacy controls**. Historical APK: tap **Shield**. Settings attempt to reduce selected tracking surfaces and can break sites. Use Apply & Reload after changing options. Screenshot protection can be switched off; it is not absolute even when enabled. On-screen checks are illustrative, not security certification.

Request log

Newer build: Menu → **Request log**. It lists some observed or blocked requests and can copy or clear the log. WebView does not report all requests or the corresponding response status, headers or bodies here. URLs may be sensitive.

Historical APK warning: its Traffic display can label requests “200 OK” without knowing the actual response and can suggest a HAR export. Do not rely on its status or export as evidence of real responses.

10 What a website can see about you

This is the question people ask most, so here it is plainly. The table is about one website in one tab, before you sign in. "Ordinary browser" means Chrome or Edge on the same phone.

What the site learns	Ordinary browser	Browz mobile
Your IP address and the region it implies	Visible	**Still visible** — there is no VPN or Tor inside Browz
Phone model, Android version, browser name	Visible	Replaced with a chosen profile (Pixel 9, iPhone, Windows PC, Firefox-style)
Screen size, graphics card name, CPU core count	Visible	Screen and graphics are replaced; core count is always reported as 8
Drawing and audio fingerprint	Stable and unique	Made slightly different on purpose (canvas, audio, WebGL), same within a session
Clock and timezone	Your real one	Reported as the profile timezone (UTC), including what pages print from a date
Whether the browser is being automated	Exposed	Reported as "no"
Ad and tracker cookies from other domains	Usually allowed	Blocked
Requests to known tracker domains	Sent	Stopped before they leave the phone
WebRTC (may reveal more about your network)	Allowed	Blocked, which also breaks some video calls
Access to your installed fonts and plugin list	Visible	**Not hidden** — a known gap

After you sign in, the shield is no longer the main question

Logging in hands the site a name: a cookie or token that says "this is account #12345". From then on the site does not need to fingerprint you, because you told it who you are. It also learns your email, your password, and every page you open on that site while signed in. No browser can hide that, and Browz does not pretend to.

• **Still hidden after login:** other sites receive no such cookie, third-party trackers in the page stay blocked, and the device details you present are the profile, not your real phone.

• **Not hidden after login:** the site knows it is you, it can link this visit to the last one, and it sees your IP address.

• **What actually separates two logins is a container, not the shield.** Use Menu → Containers and open each identity in its own container so one site cannot see the other's cookies.

One thing that was fixed because of this question: the browser used to announce the profile timezone (UTC) to scripts, but still printed the phone's real local time when a page asked for a date as text. That mismatch was a giveaway. Every date rendering now uses the profile timezone, and the test that proves it runs on a test phone deliberately set to India time, so a regression fails the build instead of passing quietly.

Three questions people ask next

Question	Short answer
Does this make me anonymous?	No. A site still sees your address and can still recognise a returning pattern from its own logs. Browz reduces what is collected; it does not hide who you are.
Can a site tell Browz from Chrome?	Sometimes. Installed fonts and the plugin list are still readable, and a page can measure many small details at once. Treat the profile as a costume, not a disguise.
Is it safe for banking and email?	Traffic is still HTTPS with certificate checks on, so keep them on and keep Android System WebView updated. Do not disable protections on a site that holds your money.

11 How this build was checked (and what can still fail)

Every published preview build passes two automatic gates. The first inspects the signed APK file itself; the second runs the app on an Android 34 test phone image.

Gate 1: the APK file is inspected, not the source

1. Package name, version 1.0.3 and Android target level 34 are confirmed.

2. The file must not be debuggable, and must request only the internet permission: no camera, microphone, location, contacts, SMS or storage access exists to misuse.

3. Backups are disabled, plain HTTP is refused, and only built-in system certificates are trusted, so a user-installed fake certificate cannot read the traffic.

4. Exactly one component may be reachable from other apps, and the file must be signed with the modern v2 and v3 signature schemes.

5. The build fails if the exposed historical key is used without an explicit preview flag, so a trusted release cannot be cut by mistake.

Gate 2: the app runs real attacks on a test phone

Four test suites run on the emulator. They send real requests through the browser code and check that analytics, loopback addresses (including [::1], 0x7f000001 and localhost.localdomain) and cloud-metadata addresses are stopped, that a blocked rule wins over the built-in list, and that a normal request is still forwarded. They plant a cookie, switch container, and confirm the cookie is gone; they simulate a crash and confirm the session does not survive a relaunch; they try a forged call into the browser’s internal interface; they check download blocking, the file-picker block, the screenshot flag and the injected shield.

They also fuzz the address bar with 300 random hostile strings and assert nothing can resolve to a script, a local file or an app link; check that a malicious URL cannot inject script into the error page; and confirm 48 dp touch targets, readable contrast and a usable page in both orientations.

Separately, the browser now refuses to let a page open the system file picker on its own, and audio cannot autoplay before you touch the page.

> **What these tests cannot promise:** they are this project's own tests, not an independent audit. Only an emulator has run them, so real phones, older WebView versions, foldables and low-memory devices are untested. A WebView security bug is fixed by Google, not here. Browz is not a VPN or Tor, so your address stays visible to sites and your operator. Fingerprinting, accessibility services, a rooted device and a compromised signing key remain real risks.

See THREAT-MODEL.md in the repository for the scenario-by-scenario table, the exact commands, and the list of unverified areas.

12 Privacy, access and troubleshooting

Who can see your information?

• **Websites and networks:** sites can see your IP; the network provider can observe destination metadata. HTTPS protects content in transit but does not provide anonymity.

• **Device and apps:** a compromised OS, administrators, accessibility services, keyboards, malware or privileged tools may see data. Ordinary Android app sandboxing helps, but is not a guarantee against these threats.

• **Exports and clipboard:** traffic files, shared links, bookmarks and copied URLs may include sensitive information. Treat them like credentials.

When something does not work

Problem	Try this
Site does not load	Check connection and URL, then Reload. Some pages need permissions or features Browz restricts. Do not disable protections for untrusted sites.
Video or login is broken	Try the site’s own controls; review settings one at a time and reload. Video fit and injected shields are not compatible with every site.
Android install/update conflict	Compare the installed and proposed signing certificates; package name alone is insufficient. Do not uninstall until you understand data loss. The exposed signing key requires migration.
Need separate Android accounts	Do not use low-cache/Ghost tabs for isolation. Use a browser designed and tested for separate profiles or a suitable OS profile.
Traffic looks incomplete	This is expected: capture is partial, especially on Android. Use independently verified network tools when accuracy is important.

13 Testing and current limitations

The newer Android app was built and ran a small number of UI tests on an Android 34 emulator. Those tests cover toolbar visibility, menu/tabs access and bookmark persistence. They do not establish real-device usability, website compatibility, security, privacy or account isolation.

About a trusted APK: the exposed signing key cannot be trusted again. A trustworthy update needs a key that only the maintainer holds, configured as repository Actions secrets; the build workflow then produces a separately signed APK and prints its certificate and checksum. Moving to such a key requires a one-time uninstall of builds signed with the exposed key.

Automated JavaScript checks also pass, but many inspect source code rather than behavior. Neither platform has received an independent security audit. The Windows public installer and historical Android APK do not include the latest unpublished Android changes.

Before relying on Browz

• Keep Android System WebView and your operating system updated.

• Avoid sensitive accounts or confidential material until security issues are addressed and independently reviewed.

• Check accessibility services, keyboards, device administration and trusted certificates on your device.

• Use a trusted and independently verified VPN or Tor where appropriate; Browz alone does not supply either.

• Watch for a securely signed Android release and migration instructions. The historical APK is not a safe signing-key update path.

Further details: Mobile parity and testing · Device and OS privacy.

Screenshots and descriptions are documentation of observed or implemented behavior, not a promise of performance or safety.